

JOE PIRES

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ABOUT

I have been a software engineer since graduating from the University of Pennsylvania. I started my career at Amazon, working on Alexa's reminder and alarm features. After Amazon, I worked at FanDuel. At FanDuel, I worked on developing two new products: Cartola FC and Faceoff. Cartola FC brought FanDuel's Daily Fantasy Sports (DFS) ecosystem to Brazil. Faceoff blended the DFS ecosystem with skill-based games. It has been a success, leading to hundreds of thousands of unique users. Throughout my career, I leveraged CI/CD, observability, and infrastructure as code. Before leaving FanDuel, I was working on implementing generosity features for FanDuel's products, including the new Predicts prediction market platform.

EDUCATION

UNIVERSITY OF PENNSYLVANIA | *Bachelor's* 2019

- Cumulative GPA: 3.45. *Cum Laude*
- Member - Pi Sigma Alpha
- Related Coursework: Algorithms, Artificial Intelligence, Machine Learning

EXPERIENCE

FANDUEL

NEW YORK, NY

Senior Software Engineer

MARCH 2023 – JUNE 2026

- Partnered with FanDuel's European teams and Flutter's Cross Product Promotion (CPP) developers to expand generosity benefits — including more flexible reward options — across FanDuel's products, driving engagement across the product suite.
- Built backend functionality for FanDuel's Picks and Predicts products, integrating both into the generosity backend to encourage cross-product usage.
- Built Beat The Pros for Faceoff, letting users compete against real sports players' stats, on FanDuel's AWS infrastructure using Terraform and Buildkite CI/CD pipelines — driving increased user engagement.
- Migrated FanDuel's notification pipeline from Segment/Braze to Hightouch using Kafka, simplifying notification delivery.
- Redesigned FanDuel's ticketing and voucher backend to split read-only and read-write database traffic across replica and primary databases, resolving a database load issue behind a prior Super Bowl outage and preventing recurrence during future high-traffic events.
- Partnered with WorldWinner to refine Faceoff — adding location-based game restrictions to stay ahead of regulatory changes, and crediting bonus Sportsbook bets to deepen cross-product engagement.

Software Engineer

NOVEMBER 2020 – MARCH 2023

- Partnered with external companies Globo and BtoBet to build the distributed backend for Cartola FC, a sports betting platform for Brazil's Serie A and the 2022 World Cup, successfully bringing FanDuel's DFS ecosystem to the Brazilian market.
- Partnered with WorldWinner to build the backend for Faceoff, blending FanDuel's DFS platform with WorldWinner's games and growing to hundreds of thousands of new users over its lifetime.

- Mentored at least half a dozen co-workers — several later promoted to Senior Software Engineer — interviewed at least a dozen+ prospective engineers, and contributed to company-wide monitoring initiatives.
- Owned Operational Excellence and on-call responsibilities for our services, special events, and product releases, lowering incident rates and downtime while maintaining service stability during high-traffic periods.

AMAZON

SANTA CLARA, CA

Software Engineer

JULY 2019 – JUNE 2020

- Updated Alexa's reminder service to help users differentiate between various types, improving reminder granularity and accuracy.
- Coordinated and drove the effort to refine the scripts used by Alexa for reminders for better translation. This helped facilitate the launch of Alexa in Brazil.

Software Development Engineering Intern

MAY 2018 – AUGUST 2018

- Worked with the Alexa Alarms team to develop a new feature to send push notifications to a user's phone, allowing them to turn off alarms from their phone rather than directly on the device.

UNIVERSITY OF PENNSYLVANIA DIGITAL SCHOLARSHIP PROGRAM

PHILADELPHIA, PA

Digital Projects Assistant

MAY 2017 – MAY 2019

- Increased functionality in and helped redesign Scalar for use in various courses, including adding automatic PDF conversion, automatic generation of books for journals, and facilitating peer reviews.
- Improved functionality in the Open Richly Annotated Cuneiform Corpus (ORACC), including adding a user registration feature, improving server functionality, and adding features used in the GUI for ORACC. This helped facilitate transliteration of cuneiform tablets.

SKILLS & INTERESTS

Proficient Java, Python, Unix, Datadog, Git, SQL

Intermediate AWS, JavaScript, HTML/CSS, Spring Boot, C#, Kafka, Terraform, Buildkite

Basic LaTeX, React, Swift, C++, Ruby, C